9/9/25

The Sermon at Benares

I Answer the following word Meanings:

1 Enlightenment: Complete understanding
sentences He achieved enlightenment after years of meditation.

2 Inscrutable: Impossible to understand
sentences Her motives remained inscrutable to everyone around.

3 Immortality: Eternal life
sentences Legends promise immortality to those who find the fountain.

4 Afflicted with: Affected by disease or serious problem
sentences She was afflicted with loneliness after moving abroad.

5 Lamentation: Expression of deep sorrow
sentences The village echoed with mourners' lamentation at dawn.

II Answer the following Reference to Context:

1 Buddha ..... Suffering.

a where did Buddha preach his first Sermon?
Ans Buddha preach his first Sermon at Benares.

b What does the Sermon preached by Buddha reflect?
Ans Buddha's sermon reflects the universality of suffering, the impermanence of life, and the path to peace through detachment, wisdom, and compassion.

c Find a word which is the same as "impossible to understand".
Ans Inscrutable

d How is Benares described in the lesson?
Ans Benares is portrayed as a sacred city on the Ganges, renowned for its spiritual significance and ancient heritage. It's where Gautama Buddha delivered his first sermon after attaining enlightenment, making it a pivotal place for spreading his message of compassion, detachment, and the truth about human suffering.

III Answer the following Short Answers:

Q1 According to Kisa Gotami what is the greatest grief of life?
Ans According to Kisa Gotami, the greatest grief of life is the death of a loved one and the realization that death is inevitable for all. Her personal loss teaches her that clinging to the dead only deepens sorrow, and true peace comes from accepting the universal nature of mortality. This insight transforms her pain into wisdom, aligning with Buddha's teachings on detachment and impermanence.

Q2 What did Siddhartha Gautama come across by chance when he was about 25 years of age?

Ans At around 25, Siddhartha Gautama came across four sights that deeply impacted him: an old man, a sick person, a dead body, and a monk who had renounced the world. These encounters revealed the realities of aging, illness, death, and spiritual pursuit, prompting him to leave his royal life in search of truth and a way to overcome human suffering.

Q3 How according to Buddha can one obtain peace of mind?

Ans According to Buddha, peace of mind comes from accepting the impermanence of life, letting go of attachment and desire, and practicing compassion and mindfulness. By understanding that suffering is universal and embracing detachment, one can attain inner calm and spiritual liberation.

Q4 Why did prince Siddhartha leave the palace and become a begar?

Ans Prince Siddhartha left his palace and become a begar after witnessing suffering in the form of of old age, sickness, and death. These sights deeply disturbed him and made him realise that wordly treasures couldn't offer lasting peace. He renounced his royal life to seek enlightenment and a path to end human suffering.

IV Answer the following Long Answers:

Q1 How does Buddha bring about a different perspective in Kisa Gotami's understanding of life?

Ans In Kisa Gotami's eyes, her son's death was a singular, unbearable grief that set her apart from all others. She wandered in denial, unable to accept mortality's universality, convinced that her loss wass uniquely tragic and solvable through ritual and remedy.

When she brought her child's lifeless body to Buddha, he refused to perform the rites she demanded. Instead he asked her to gather mustard seeds from a household untouched by death. As she moved from home to home, she discovered every family carried its own history of loss and sorrow.

Confronted with this shared human experience, Kisa Gotami realized suffering's universality and life's impermanence. He quest shifted from clinging to the past toward embracing compassion, detachment, and the path to true peace.